

```

DEVICE=eth0
HWADDR=00:1d:60:66:aa:3b
ONBOOT=yes
#BOOTPROTO=dhcp
BRIDGE=switch
USERCTL=yes
IPV6INIT=no
NM_CONTROLLED=no
TYPE=Ethernet
PEERDNS=yes

```

Now we need to create another file called `/etc/sysconfig/network-scripts/ifcfg-br0` and add the following text to it:

```

DEVICE=switch
BOOTPROTO=dhcp
ONBOOT=yes
TYPE=Bridge

```

Now restart your network as follows:

```
service network restart
```

The idea is that the bridge `br0` should get the IP address (either DHCP or static) while `eth0` is left without one. Don't ask me *why* now. I Googled for how to create a bridge so that I could use my shared physical Ethernet for networking with the guest, and found the solution at kvm.qumranet.com/kvmwiki/Networking.

That's it! Now that our initial hitch with the networking set-up is done (which we'll eventually require later), let's move on to creating a virtual machine.

Back to real business

Take a look at Figure 2 once again. You're back in this window. Click the *New* button, and you're now in Figure 3. Clicking *Forward* here will ask you to enter a name of the system that you'll create. I put 'openSUSE11.1' here as I have an openSUSE 11.1 RC KDE Live CD. After clicking *Forward* again, the next step is where we need to select the virtualisation method. Nothing much to do here as you can see in Figure 5—the paravirtualisation option is grayed out as KVM is a full virtualisation solution, unlike Xen. You will also notice in this window that the CPU architecture and hypervisor are already defined as i686 (unless your host system is an x86-64 OS) and KVM, respectively. So, just click *Forward* again.

This next window is where you'll need to define the installation method. By default, it's 'Local install media (ISO image or CDROM)'. I used this! You can also go for a Network or PXE installation, but then you're on your own. :-)

Below that you can define your guest OS type and version/distribution. By default, both are defined as 'Generic' and you may leave them as they are if you aren't too particular. Otherwise, please take a look at the options and see if it has what you're looking for.

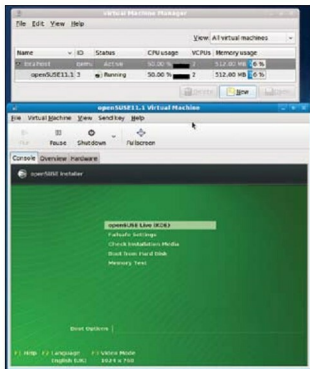


Figure 8: Virt-Manager booting the openSUSE 11.1 RC KDE Live CD

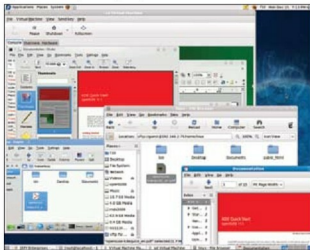


Figure 9: Accessing the guest's home directory from the host's Nautilus file manager

The following window inquires about the location of your installation media—an ISO image or a CD/DVD media. I had the openSUSE image in my hard drive, so I simply pointed to that by hitting the *Browse* button. You can also place a bootable media in your CD/DVD drive instead.

The next screen is where you'll assign storage space—a disk image file (selected by default), or a regular disk partition. I opted for the default disk image route, and was also satisfied with the predefined file size as 4000 MB—a live CD can't have more than 2.5 GB of data after installation, which leaves me more than a GB for swap and/or additional free space. So, I moved *Forward*.

The following window is where you define the